

Philipp Hilbert. *Platform Product Manager with a core systems instinct.*

Positioning, ten years of product ownership across regulated platforms, configuration engines, and internal tooling – exactly the stack N26's Product Factory runs on.

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§ WHY N26

The Product Factory problem – replacing hardcoded per-country launches with a modular, configuration-driven engine – is the same class of problem I worked on at Emil Group, where the goal was collapsing insurance product time-to-market from over a year to under a week using a centralised product configuration layer. N26's framing of "building blocks" over bespoke engineering resonates directly with that experience. The job description's emphasis on self-service tooling for regional market teams, automated compliance guardrails, and a central product catalog maps cleanly to work I have done rather than work I would need to learn. *That is precisely the environment where a PM who speaks fluent backend and has shipped configuration platforms produces outsized impact.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, accelerated feature delivery
- **GPT**, requirements drafting and edge-case generation
- **Cursor / VSCode**, daily development environment
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder and roadmap decks
- **n8n**, multi-agent and agentic workflow automation

- **Framer**, design-heavy prototyping

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, Helm, OpenShift, Docker, Jenkins, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Redpanda, Django, GitOps pipelines, Bitbucket, Git, MicroStrategy, low-code insurance platforms, CGM API integrations, and Shopware catalogue and approval-policy integrations.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT N26

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the regional market teams and core engineers to understand how financial products currently move from business request to live configuration, documenting every manual step, bottleneck, and compliance checkpoint along the way.

WEEK 2

Slice and validate.

Run structured sessions with the compliance, legal, and operations stakeholders named in the posting to validate which bottlenecks in the current product launch flow are genuinely owned by the Product Factory versus upstream or downstream dependencies.

WEEK 3+

Ship and unblock.

Deliver the first scoped improvement to the self-service configuration tooling, establish a clear roadmap review cadence with engineering and market teams, and close the first loop on a pending product catalog integrity issue.

I COVER LETTER

Dear N26 hiring team,

The Product Factory role caught my attention because it is not a generic PM position – it is a specific infrastructure problem: how do you give a rapidly expanding digital bank the ability to launch and modify financial products at speed without accumulating a backlog of bespoke engineering work? That problem has a clear shape, and it is one I have spent meaningful time on.

At Emil Group I joined an InsurTech SaaS platform with the same structural ambition – reduce time-to-market for insurance products from over a year to under a week through centralised configuration engines covering product setup, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, and document management. I owned the product roadmap for those modules, designed and delivered the Claims Center from concept to production rollout, and rebuilt the delivery process around it: splitting a bloated seventeen-person team into focused Scrum units, reintroducing velocity tracking and structured refinement, and recovering client trust through weekly product workshops. The platform architecture was modular and configuration-driven by design. That is the same architectural philosophy the Product Factory is built on.

My experience with internal tooling and platform product ownership extends across several roles. At Rohde & Schwarz I delivered a central AI data management platform for a multinational government defence programme, owning the full product lifecycle end-to-end – user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps rollout. I reduced deployment times from several days to under forty minutes by introducing ArgoCD-based GitOps. I unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift that had been open for over a year and delivered them in one week as the sole developer on that feature. At the Federal Employment Agency I served as Deputy IT Security Officer alongside my product role, managed compliance and data lineage governance, and ran ETL and indicator automation via Dagster. Both roles required the kind of backend fluency and cross-functional coordination that the Product Factory posting specifically calls out.

On vendor and third-party integration: I have managed PSP integrations at Kvitt Payment Solutions, CGM API integrations at CLINET, and a complex Shopware catalogue and approval-policy integration at AOK. Each of these required aligning an external roadmap with internal engineering priorities and building compliance guardrails directly into the integration layer rather than bolting them on afterwards.

N26 is building the platform layer that makes the rest of the bank fast. That is unglamorous, load-bearing infrastructure work, and it is the kind of work I find genuinely interesting. I would be glad to discuss how my background maps to the specific challenges your core systems team is working through.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience across regulated platforms, internal configuration engines, and infrastructure-level tooling. Delivered across InsurTech SaaS, public-sector analytics platforms, and a multinational AI data management programme. Comfortable owning complex product catalogs, self-service configuration tools, and cross-functional compliance rollouts. Fluent in backend architecture, API product design, and agile delivery at the platform layer. Operates with a founder's pragmatism: low process overhead, high ownership, direct communication with engineering.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Modular platform and configuration engine product ownership
 - Internal self-service tooling strategy and delivery
 - Backend and API product design with direct engineering collaboration
 - Cross-functional compliance and regulatory guardrail design
 - Agile restructuring and sprint discipline recovery
 - ETL and data pipeline product ownership
 - Vendor and third-party integration management
 - End-to-end autonomous feature delivery in complex regulated environments
 - Stakeholder trust recovery in prototype-stage and high-pressure programmes
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

EMIL GROUP 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Owned the product roadmap for a B2B configuration platform reducing insurance product time-to-market from over one year to under one week across product setup, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, and document management modules
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Re-established sprint discipline by splitting a bloated seventeen-person team into focused Scrum units and reintroducing velocity tracking and structured refinement

- Regained client trust through weekly product workshops and structured communication of technical complexity
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Owned a central AI and data management platform for multimodal datasets within the European defence programme FCAS, including data transformation, provenance, and audit trails
- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; delivered in one week a feature that had been open with the engineering team for over a year
- Led a cross-functional team including architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA across multinational stakeholders

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Advanced the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform, delivering labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison tooling, and modernised admin features
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation, standardised CI/CD with full test integration
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance governance and data lineage
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major platform upgrades

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core patient-facing flows for a mobile-first hospital pilot across iOS and Android, including digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and document storage
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows, managing legacy API constraints transparently with stakeholders
- Led a small team under tight deadlines with strict prioritisation on highest-leverage features

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Founded a group-based P2P payment product on a P2P backbone, owned full UX/UI design and mobile app prototype, managed PSP integration end-to-end
- Later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner

- Owned product architecture for a quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware; deputy IT security officer
- Core USP: full setup in under two minutes, no technical knowledge required from the end user

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES 2016, 2021

Co-Founder, CDO, CFO, Project Lead

- Established digital tooling, financial and investment planning, and ERP for an agritech deep-tech venture across multiple founder roles

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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